

Plaid

Fintech · Open Banking / Financial Data Network · San Francisco, CA · Private (~\$8B; IPO-track, unhurried)

Plaid - the open-banking data network behind much of modern finance - was valued at ~\$8B in a Feb 2026 tender offer, just installed a new CMO and President, and is IPO-tracked but unhurried, with no motorsport footprint and an open fintech lane on Formula E's American team.

71

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Andretti Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Plaid - the financial-data network behind much of open banking - was valued at roughly \$8B in a February 2026 employee tender offer, up 31% from the \$6.1B at which it sold about \$575M of stock a year earlier. It has just reset its brand leadership: Hannah Hughes joined as CMO and Jen Taylor (ex-Cloudflare Chief Product Officer) as its first President, so the brand and partnership agenda is being written right now. Co-founder and CEO Zach Perret has been candid that he does not see IPO conditions as favourable yet and the company has not filed an S-1 - so this is a pre-listing brand-building window, not a dated scramble. While F1's fintech lane is saturated (Visa, Revolut, Mastercard), Formula E's is open: no open-banking or financial-data brand holds an FE team deal, and Andretti - the American team - lists fintech as an open category, a clean match for an American open-banking leader.

WHY NOW

A new CMO's first two quarters are when marquee brand investments are chosen, and Plaid has installed both a new CMO and a first President at once - the classic leadership-honeymoon window. With an IPO on the horizon (even if unhurried) brand credibility compounds now, and the FE fintech lane is uncontested - move before a rival notices the open American seat at Andretti.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$8B

Valuation (Feb 2026 employee tender offer, +31%)

\$575M

Secondary stock sale at a \$6.1B valuation (prior round)

Jen Taylor

First President (joined from Cloudflare, ex-Chief Product Officer)

Zachary Perret

Co-founder & CEO; sees IPO conditions as not yet favourable, no S-1 filed

Hannah Hughes

CMO (decision-maker), joined 2026

Andretti FE - fintech open

Recommended team's fintech lane is open (roster: TWG AI, Quest Global, NAGASE - no financial partner)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Andretti	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	TAKEN	financial services
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Nissan	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

Valued at ~\$8B (Feb 2026), with a brand-new CMO and President and an IPO on the horizon, Plaid is in its brand-building window - and Formula E's fintech lane is empty. Andretti, the American team, lists fintech as open: an American open-banking leader can own it before the listing.

FUNDING EVENT

NEW LEADERSHIP

NEVER ENTERED

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY ANDRETTI FORMULA E

Andretti Formula E is the sharpest fit: an American team for an American open-banking leader, and one that explicitly lists fintech as an open category - so Plaid can own it outright rather than share it. Its roster (TWG AI, Quest Global, engineering and materials partners) carries no financial-services brand, so there is no category clash, and its innovation-and-enterprise positioning suits Plaid's 'trusted financial infrastructure' story. (Jaguar TCS, the obvious prior candidate, has since signed Chase as its Official Financial Services Partner, which closes that lane - a reminder to move while Andretti's is open.)

VALUE TO ANDRETTI FORMULA E — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B. Plaid's financial-data and payments infrastructure maps to a racing organisation's partner-onboarding, settlement and treasury flows rather than to the car, but the value exchange is real: Andretti gains modern financial connectivity and a fintech co-marketing partner, while Plaid gains a premium, American, enterprise-credible stage and hospitality in front of the banks and fintechs it sells to. The honest framing is a commercial and brand partnership, not an in-car integration.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Financial Infrastructure / Fintech Partner tier on Andretti Formula E, minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr, with category exclusivity for open-banking/financial-data and B2B hospitality aimed at Plaid's enterprise audience.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Hannah Hughes

CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, PLAID (JOINED 2026) - VERIFIED

Joined Plaid as Chief Marketing Officer in 2026 and is actively setting the brand and partnership agenda a Formula E deal would anchor. Co-decision-makers: President Jen Taylor (joined from Cloudflare, where she was Chief Product Officer) and co-founder & CEO Zachary Perret.

OPENING ANGLE

"Hannah, F1's fintech lane is full - Formula E's is empty, and Andretti, the American team, lists fintech as open. An American open-banking leader owning that lane before the IPO - and as the new CMO it's yours to define. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING

16 / 20

A new CMO and a first President installed for 2026 are setting brand strategy now (the leadership-honeymoon window), and a \$8B tender offer in Feb 2026 marks fresh momentum.

CAPACITY

17 / 20

~\$8B valuation (Feb 2026 tender, up 31% from \$6.1B a year earlier) - ample capacity for an FE entry tier.

BRAND FIT

15 / 20

Open-banking/financial-data has a clean trust-and-infrastructure story; an American open-banking leader fits the American FE team, and avoids the saturated F1 fintech lane.

URGENCY

12 / 20

Leadership reset plus an IPO on the horizon, but the CEO is in no rush and there is no dated calendar anchor.

OPS FIT

11 / 20

MODE B: financial-data infrastructure serves back-office/partner flows rather than the car.

RISKS & COUNTERS

B2B VS CONSUMER REACH Leadership may question motorsport for an infrastructure brand. **Counter:** Frame as enterprise trust and credibility with banks/fintechs, on a B2B-credible team - not consumer reach; lead with pipeline and partner-audience metrics.

IPO NOT IMMINENT The CEO sees listing conditions as unfavourable and no S-1 is filed, so the urgency is softer. **Counter:** That is the argument FOR moving now: lock category exclusivity at a pre-IPO price while the lane is open and cheap, and let activation scale into the eventual listing.

SOURCES

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